Alexander Pumbaya Mama-o

Datu Alexander P. Mama-o (Hadji AbdulRauf Pumbaya Mama-o), Cabugatan sa Bayang, is a Bangsamoro public servant and transportation reformer from Rinabor, Bayang, Lanao del Sur. He spent most of his career in one demanding corner of government: regulating the transportation sector. Along the way he kept pushing for better governance and for programs that make daily life easier for ordinary people.

His working life covers a lot of ground. There were years in government offices, years as a worker overseas, and years leading communities. It took him from small towns in Mindanao to national government institutions, and it makes him a fine example of what a Bangsamoro professional can offer the country.

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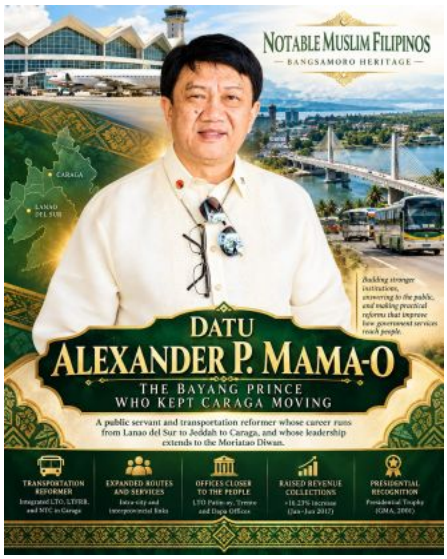
Early Years and Life Abroad

Datu Alexander earned his Bachelor of Science in Social Work at Philippine Christian University in 1974. He started working a year later, with stints in banking, education, and social welfare.

By 1976 he was wearing two hats: college instructor at Pacasum College in Marawi City, and Senior Social Welfare Officer of the Department of Social Welfare and Development (DSWD) in Malabang, Lanao del Sur. He helped set up social welfare services for the province, and he led the split of DSWD Lanao del Sur into two district offices so that more people could reach essential services. He then headed the 2nd District.

In 1978 he went to the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia as an Overseas Filipino Worker. His job at Jeddah International Airport was in aviation and production control. Off the clock, he pioneered a Jeddah-based Filipino group that helped repatriate hundreds of Muslim and Christian Filipino workers who had left their employers and sought refuge at the Philippine Embassy.

Datu Alexander P. Mama-o



Also Known As

Hadji AbdulRauf Pumbaya Mama-o

Origin

Rinabor, Bayang, Lanao del Sur

Royal Title

Cabugatan sa Bayang (crowned 2015), Royal House of Bayang

Public Service

DSWD, LTFRB, LTO, TELOF, DOTC and DOTr; founding Regional Director of DOTC Caraga

Education

BS Social Work, Philippine Christian University (1974); MBA, Agusan Institute of Technology (1997)

Civic Roles

Chairman, Moriatao Diwan National Directorate Council (since 2008); Chairman, Filipino Muslim Alliance for Integrity and Reform Movement (since 2012)

Notability

A Bangsamoro public servant whose decades in transportation regulation shaped how land transport and telecommunications offices reach people in the Caraga Region, and a crowned Prince of the Royal House of Bayang.

Known For

Building the integrated DOTC Caraga Regional Office, opening LTO district offices, expanding intra-city and interprovincial routes, and carrying

Reshaping Transportation in Caraga

He came home in 1986 and went back into government, this time on the road of transportation administration and reform. He held leadership posts in the Land Transportation Franchising and Regulatory Board (LTFRB), the Land Transportation Office (LTO), and the former Telecommunications Office (TELOF), all under the Department of Transportation and Communications (DOTC), now the Department of Transportation (DOTr).

Bayang royal heritage into civic leadership.

Pull Quote

"From Rinabor to Jeddah to Caraga, the work stayed the same: keep people and services moving, and make life a little easier for ordinary folks."

When the Caraga region was created, he became the pioneer and founding Regional Director of the DOTC there, separating its operations from DOTC Region X in Cagayan de Oro City.

Over his years of service he was assigned to Marawi City, Cagayan de Oro City, Butuan City, Cebu City, Zamboanga City, and Baguio City. Caraga is where he left some of his biggest marks:

- **One roof for transport offices.** He pioneered an integrated DOTC Caraga Regional Office that brought the LTO, the LTFRB, and the National Telecommunications Commission (NTC) together.
- **Easier trips within cities.** He helped establish intra-city routes in Caraga, giving students, professionals, workers, and other commuters a way to get around.
- **Wider links between provinces.** In 1997, working with local government officials, he helped expand interprovincial routes to keep people, goods, and services moving and to support the region's economic growth.
- **Government offices closer to the people.** In 1997 he pioneered the LTO Patin-ay District Office and the LTO Trento Extension Office, and in 1998 he oversaw the reopening of the LTO Dapa Office.
- **Telecommunications projects delivered.** He completed seven NTC projects serving communities in Butuan, Nasipit, Magallanes, Surigao City, Prosperidad, Mangagoy, and other parts of Caraga.

Results and Recognition

The numbers from his later years in Caraga speak for themselves. From January to June 2017, while he served as Regional Director of the DOTr Caraga Regional Office, the office's revenue collections rose by ₱24,832,365.88, a 16.23% increase over baseline collections.

He is also a recipient of a Presidential Trophy from former President Gloria Macapagal Arroyo, given for the strong performance of the regional transportation agencies in Caraga and their contribution to national revenue collections. It came with the administration's recognition of the LTO's achievements in 2001.

In 2016 he was re-appointed DOTr Regional Director for Caraga Region XIII, and he took his oath of office before then Court of Appeals Associate Justice Japar B. Dimaampao. His appointments as a DOTC executive carry the signatures of four presidents in turn: Fidel V. Ramos, Joseph Estrada, Gloria Macapagal Arroyo, and Rodrigo Roa Duterte.

Studies

After his social work degree in 1974, he completed a Master in Business Administration at the Agusan Institute of Technology in 1997, under a consortium with Southwestern University.

Royal Title and Bangsamoro Roots

In 2015, Datu Alexander was proclaimed a crowned Prince (Cabugatan) of the Royal House of Bayang, Lanao del Sur, one of the 16 Royal Houses of Lanao.

He was crowned Cabugatan sa Bayang as a descendant of Cabugatan, who was the son of Amerodin, son of Amdag, son of Diwan. Under the traditional system of succession based on the ancient local law known as *Ijma ago Taritib*, Cabugatan is next in line to the throne of the Sultanate of Bayang during the turn of Amerodin, the eldest son of Amdag, in the order of succession. On his mother's side, he also traces his royal lineage to the Sultanate of Pagayawan, as a grandson of Cali sa Unayan.

Civic Leadership

Since 2008 he has chaired the Moriatao Diwan (Descendants of Diwan) National Directorate Council, and since 2012 he has chaired the Filipino Muslim Alliance for Integrity and Reform Movement. His civic involvement also reaches Muslim community organizations and initiatives tied to peace, democracy, and federalism.

His years in Saudi Arabia in the late 1970s and early 1980s had a Bangsamoro side too. He took an active part in the efforts of the Bangsa Moro Liberation Organization, founded by the late Haroun Al-Rashid Lucman, which worked to unite Moro leaders in the Middle East behind a call for a peaceful resolution of the armed conflict in Mindanao.

These roles are a big part of how he is known publicly. They tie his professional career back to his roots and to the continuing importance of traditional institutions in Lanao del Sur.

Two Careers, One Thread

Datu Alexander P. Mama-o's working life shows the many ways Muslim Filipinos and Bangsamoro leaders have contributed to Philippine public administration, regional development, and community life.

He started with social welfare work in Lanao del Sur, led transportation offices in Caraga, helped fellow Filipino workers in Saudi Arabia, and took part in traditional leadership institutions at home. The thread through all of it is steady engagement with public service and with the communities around him.

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